

SIBLING RIVALRY RESOLUTION TOOLKIT

Conflict Scripts, Bonding Activities & Peace Corner Setup

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WHY SIBLINGS FIGHT

Sibling conflict is NORMAL and even healthy when managed well.

- Competition for parent attention (the #1 driver)
- Developmental differences (older vs younger abilities)
- Temperament clashes (introvert vs extrovert)
- Boredom and proximity
- Feeling unfairly treated

Your goal is NOT to eliminate conflict but to teach conflict resolution.

CONFLICT RESOLUTION SCRIPTS FOR PARENTS

When they're fighting over a toy:

"I see two kids who both want the same toy. What can we do?"

Options: Timer (5 min each) | Trade for something else | Play together

When one hits/hurts the other:

"Stop. Hitting is not okay. [To victim]: Are you okay? [To hitter]:"

"I can see you were angry. Hitting hurts. What could you do instead?"

When they tattle:

"Is someone hurt or in danger? No? Then can you try solving it first?"

"Tell your brother how you feel using I-statements."

When they say 'It's not fair!':

"Fair doesn't mean everyone gets the same. It means everyone gets what they NEED."

"What do YOU need right now?"

When the older child is mean to the younger:

"I know it can be hard having a little sibling. They look up to you so much."

"Would you like some time alone? Or some just-you-and-me time?"

THE PEACE CORNER (Conflict Resolution Station)

Set up a designated space where siblings go to resolve conflicts:

What to include:

- Peace agreement poster (rules posted)
- Timer (for taking turns talking)
- Feelings faces chart
- Problem-solving wheel (spin for solutions)
- 'I feel...' sentence starter cards

Peace Corner Rules:

1. One person talks at a time (hold the talking stick)
2. Use 'I feel...' not 'You always...'
3. Listen without interrupting
4. Brainstorm solutions together
5. Agree on one solution to try
6. Shake hands or high-five

SIBLING BONDING ACTIVITIES (Do Together)

Cooperative (not competitive) activities:

1. Build a blanket fort together
2. Cook or bake something as a team
3. Create a sibling secret handshake
4. Make a time capsule together
5. Collaborate on an art project
6. Put on a show for parents
7. Build something with blocks/LEGO together
8. Start a 'sibling business' (lemonade stand)
9. Read to each other before bed
10. Work on a puzzle together
11. Plan a surprise for a parent together
12. Create a comic strip starring both of them

PREVENTING FIGHTS: DAILY STRATEGIES

- Give each child 10 minutes of individual attention daily
- Notice and praise when they get along (not just when they fight)
- Avoid comparing ('Your sister never does that!')
- Give specific roles ('You're the mixer, you're the pourer')
- Separate when overstimulated (before the meltdown)
- Let them solve minor conflicts themselves (don't always referee)
- Family meetings to address recurring issues

ONE-ON-ONE TIME TRACKER

Each child needs regular individual time with each parent:

Child: _____ This week's special time:

MON: ____ min Activity: _____

TUE: ____ min Activity: _____

WED: ____ min Activity: _____

THU: ____ min Activity: _____

FRI: ____ min Activity: _____

Child: _____ This week's special time:

MON: ____ min Activity: _____

TUE: ____ min Activity: _____

WED: ____ min Activity: _____

THU: ____ min Activity: _____

FRI: ____ min Activity: _____

By Daniel Tesfamariam | Siblings are practicing for all future relationships.